Deep Competitive Profiles: Vanta, Drata, CrowdStrike

Vanta leads the compliance automation market at ~$220M ARR and a $4.15B valuation, roughly 2× Drata's scale. Drata crossed $100M ARR in early 2025 and is aggressively closing the gap through M&A ($250M SafeBase acquisition). CrowdStrike operates in a fundamentally different category — endpoint security at ~$4.9B ARR (Yahoo Finance) and ~$104B market cap — but is a strategic investor in Vanta and a data source for both compliance platforms. The three companies are more complementary than competitive, though the whitespace in AI governance compliance, SMB-affordable tooling, and international frameworks remains vast and largely unaddressed.

Side-by-side comparison table

Metric	Vanta	Drata	CrowdStrike (CRWD)
Founded	2018 (YC W18)	June 2020	2011
HQ	San Francisco, CA	San Diego, CA	Austin, TX
Category	Compliance automation / Trust management	Compliance automation / Trust management	Endpoint security / XDR p
ARR	~$220M [est., Sacra Jul 2025]; $100M+ confirmed (Jan 2024)	**$100M** (company-confirmed, Feb 2025)	**$4.92B** (Q3 FY2026, Oct filing)
ARR growth YoY	~45% [est., Sacra 2024→2025]	**60%** (company-stated, FY25)	**23%** YoY (Q3 FY2026; S
Total funding raised	**$504M** (6 rounds)	**$328.2M** (4 rounds)	~$481M pre-IPO + $612M

Metric	Vanta	Drata	CrowdStrike (CRWD)
Latest valuation / market cap	**$4.15B** (Series D, Jul 2025)	**$2.0B** (Series C, Dec 2022) ⚠️ *>3 yrs old*	**~$104B** market cap (Feb 2
Paying customers	**15,000+** (Feb 2026; Vanta Trust Center)	**8,000+** (Nov 2025; PR)	**~30,000** (FY2025 10-K es
Employees	~1,100–1,400 [est., multiple sources, Feb 2026]	~700–732 (Tracxn/TrueUp, Jan 2026)	~11,075 (Tracxn, Jan 202
Profitability	Not profitable; highly capital-efficient	Not profitable; CFO hired Nov 2025 (IPO signal)	Non-GAAP profitable ($9 FY2025); GAAP net loss FY2025
FCF	Not disclosed; "hasn't touched Series C capital"	Not disclosed	**$1.065B** FY2025 (27% m
Frameworks supported	**35+**	**25+**	N/A (security platform, no automation)
Integrations	**375–400+**	**170+**	100s of marketplace integ
Pricing entry point	~$10,000/yr	~$7,500/yr	~$30/endpoint/yr (Falcon
Key differentiator	Largest customer base; most integrations; hourly monitoring	Aggressive M&A (SafeBase, Oak9); single-tenant DB; AI agents	Falcon platform; 20+ secu 60% of Fortune 500
Crunchbase URL	crunchbase.com/organization/vanta	crunchbase.com/organization/drata	crunchbase.com/organizat

⚠️ **Data freshness notes:** Vanta's ARR beyond $100M is estimated by Sacra (third-party research firm), not company-confirmed. Drata's $2B valuation dates to December 2022 (Tracxn) — no primary fundraise since. CrowdStrike financials are from SEC filings and are the most reliable figures in this analysis.

Vanta: the compliance automation market leader

Financial trajectory and capital efficiency

Vanta was founded in 2018 by Christina Cacioppo (ex-Dropbox PM, ex-Union Square Ventures) and graduated from Y Combinator's W18 batch with just **$3M in seed funding**. (Miikahuttunen) The company operated at near cash-flow breakeven on that $3M alone for roughly three years (SaaStr) — an extraordinary display of capital discipline that remains central to its investor narrative. (SaaStr)

The ARR trajectory tells a compelling compounding story:

Period	ARR	Source & date
May 2021 (Series A)	>$10M	Vanta blog, Forbes (May 2021)
Mid-2023	~$80M [est.]	Sacra (Jul 2025)
Jan 2024 (FY24)	**$100M+**	Vanta blog (Apr 2024) — **company-confirmed**
End of 2024	~$152M [est.]	Sacra (Jul 2025)
Jul 2025	~$220M [est.]	Sacra (Jul 2025)

Cross-reference note: CEO Cacioppo told CNBC (Jul 2025) that growth is "in the ballpark of the best SaaS companies" but declined to confirm specific figures. The only company-confirmed ARR milestones are >$10M (May 2021) and $100M+ (Jan 2024). (Vanta) All other figures are Sacra estimates and should be cited as such.

Total funding reached **$504M** across six rounds, Texau with the July 2025 Series D ($150M led by Wellington Management) valuing the company at **$4.15B** — a 69% step-up from the $2.45B Series C just one year prior. SaaStr +2 Key strategic investors include CrowdStrike Ventures (invested since October 2022's $40M extension), CrowdStrike Sequoia Capital, Goldman Sachs, J.P. Morgan, and Atlassian Ventures. Business Wire TechCrunch Cacioppo stated the company "hasn't touched any of the $150 million it raised" in its Series C, indicating a strong cash position despite no profitability disclosure. Tech Startups CNBC

Scale and growth archaeology

Vanta's customer count has compounded steadily: **1,000 at Series A → 4,000 at the B extension → 7,000 at FY24 close → 12,000 at Series D** Sacra **→ 15,000+ as of February 2026** (per Vanta's Trust Center page). Vanta Average revenue per customer has risen from ~$14K (early 2024) to ~$18K (mid-2025) per Sacra estimates, reflecting the upmarket push. Sacra Sacra

The early go-to-market strategy was brilliant in its simplicity. Cacioppo sold directly to YC startups that needed SOC 2 compliance to close enterprise deals. **Three-quarters of every YC cohort now uses Vanta** Sacra — a self-reinforcing network effect where the fastest-growing startups become Vanta customers before they even scale. The product at seed stage was literally a color-coded spreadsheet ("Vanta V0") SaaStr paired with 5:45 AM manual emails to customers. SaaStr Miikahuttunen Today it supports **35+ compliance frameworks, 375+ integrations,** Sacra **AI-powered questionnaire automation with 95% acceptance rate**, Business Wire and an "Agentic Trust Platform" unveiled at VantaCon in November 2025. Vanta Business Wire

Notable enterprise logos include **Atlassian, Duolingo, Ramp, Snowflake, Mistral AI,** Business Wire **ZoomInfo,** LinkedIn **Miro, Icelandair, and Omni Hotels**. Business Wire FinTech Global The company operates across **58 countries** Business Wire with ~25% of customers outside the U.S., supported by offices in San Francisco, New York, Dublin, London, and Sydney. Business Wire TechCrunch

Employee count shows some source discrepancy: TrueUp/PitchBook report ~1,400 TrueUp as of early 2026, while other sources suggest 1,100+. BankInfoSecurity The company Tech Startups laid off 53 employees (~14%) in December 2022 but has since grown aggressively — roughly doubling headcount from ~500 (mid-2024) TechCrunch to the current range.

Product and pricing

Vanta sells annual SaaS subscriptions across tiered plans. Pricing is not publicly listed, but third-party intelligence (Vendr, Spendflo, ComplyJet) suggests: **Core tier at ~$10,000/yr** for a startup's first SOC 2, scaling to **$50,000–$80,000+/yr** for enterprise. Add-on frameworks cost ~$5,000 each; Trust Center ~$6,000/yr; vendor risk management ~$11,200/yr. Complyjet Median deal size is approximately **$19,000/yr** per Vendr data. Aggressive discounting (25–60%) is common for multi-year deals and competitive situations.

Key product differentiators include **hourly continuous monitoring** (vs. Drata's daily), the industry's largest integration library (375+), Vanta cross-framework control mapping ("do the work once"), Sacra and FedRAMP 20x Low Authorization (first cohort). Sacra Business Wire An IDC study (January 2025) reported **526% ROI over three years** Complyjet with a 3-month payback period.

Drata: the fast-following challenger

Financial trajectory and M&A-driven strategy

Drata was founded in June 2020 by Adam Markowitz Bright Defense — a former aerospace engineer who designed liquid rocket engines for NASA's Space Shuttle Main Engine. After his first company (Portfolium, an edtech platform) was acquired by Instructure for $43M in 2019, Markowitz experienced compliance pain firsthand and built Drata to solve it. contrary The first lines of code were written in July 2020; the product launched in January 2021.

The growth from zero to $100M ARR in roughly **3.5 years** PR Newswire places Drata among the fastest SaaS companies to reach that milestone, alongside Wiz, Deel, and Ramp. The financial trajectory:

Period	ARR	Source & date
2021	<$1M at Series A (Jun 2021)	Notable Capital blog (Feb 2025)
2022	~$30M [est.]	Sacra (Jan 2025)
2023	~$59M [est.]	Sacra (Jan 2025)
Feb 2025	**$100M**	Drata PR Newswire (Feb 19, 2025) — **company-confirmed**

Cross-reference note: Sacra estimates $95M for calendar 2024; Sacra getlatka reports $90M; Drata's own press release (Feb 2025) claims "$100M ARR" crossed with "60% YoY global revenue growth." PR Newswire These figures are roughly consistent if Drata's fiscal year ends in January/February, with the $100M milestone hit at year-end.

Total funding stands at **$328.2M** across four rounds. Tracxn The $200M Series C (December 2022, co-led by ICONIQ Growth and GGV Capital) valued Drata at **$2.0B** — but critically, this is now over three years old. No primary fundraise has occurred since. The company has instead deployed capital aggressively on M&A: **Harmonize.io** (April 2024, user access governance), **Oak9** (May 2024, compliance-as-code), Prospect and the marquee **SafeBase acquisition for $250M** (February 2025), which brought Trust Center capabilities and 1,000+ enterprise customers including LinkedIn, Palantir, and CrowdStrike.

The path to profitability is unclear but the signals suggest IPO preparation. Drata conducted two rounds of layoffs in 2024 (14% in February, 9% in September) citing "operational efficiency" OpenTools.ai and hired **Aneal Vallurupalli as CFO in November 2025** PR Newswire — a hire with public-company readiness experience at Guidewire and Airbase. CFOtech Australia Internal communications referenced "charting a course toward a potential IPO." Jaunt

Scale and customer base

Customer count has grown from 100 within 45 days of launch contrary to **4,000+ (Feb 2024) → 7,000+ (Feb 2025) → 8,000+ (Nov 2025)**. TechMagic Notable logos include **Notion, OpenAI, LinkedIn, Okta,**

SentinelOne, Brex, BambooHR, Calendly, Vercel, and Asana. One-third of the Forbes Cloud 100 reportedly uses Drata. (PR Newswire) The company serves customers in **60+ countries**, (PR Newswire) with international expansion accelerating through channel partnerships with Exclusive Networks (UK, DACH, Nordics) and Netpoleon (APAC). A new Sydney office and APAC data center opened in October 2025. (PR Newswire)

Employee count rebounded to **~700–732** (Tracxn) (Tracxn/TrueUp, January 2026) after the 2024 layoffs, likely boosted by the SafeBase team integration.

Product and pricing

Drata sells a "Trust Management Platform" across six pricing tiers. Entry-level Essential plans start at approximately **$7,500/yr** — slightly below Vanta's entry point. (Comp AI) Mid-tier plans run **$15,000–$25,000/yr**, with enterprise contracts exceeding $100,000/yr. Average contract value is approximately **$13,500** per Sacra estimates. (Sacra) The company supports **25+ compliance frameworks and 170+ integrations**. (Sacra) (TechMagic)

Key differentiators include **single-tenant database architecture** (unique in the space), the only platform offering **Compliance as Code** (via Oak9, scanning infrastructure-as-code pre-deployment), (Drata) the SafeBase Trust Center network, and an AI Agent for vendor risk management launched in August 2025. (PR Newswire) Drata was first to support NIST AI RMF and has added ISO 42001, (Cycoresecure) DORA, and NIS2 (Comp AI) — positioning ahead of Vanta on some emerging regulatory frameworks.

CrowdStrike: the cybersecurity giant in a different orbit

Financial profile of a $100B+ platform

CrowdStrike is a fundamentally different animal. Founded in 2011 by George Kurtz (ex-McAfee CTO) and Dmitri Alperovitch, (Wikipedia) (Exa) it went public in June 2019 at $34/share, (CNBC) closing its first day at ~$58 (an 83% pop). (Dark Reading) The company now trades at approximately **$422/share with a ~$104B market cap** (February 2026). (Benzinga)

The financial metrics are public-company grade, sourced directly from SEC filings:

Metric	Figure	Source
Ending ARR (Q3 FY2026, Oct 31, 2025)	**$4.92B**	CrowdStrike IR press release (Dec 2, 2025)
Net new ARR (Q3 FY2026)	**$265M** (record)	CrowdStrike IR press release
Total revenue (FY2025, ended Jan 31, 2025)	**$3.954B** (+29% YoY)	FY2025 annual results (Mar 4, 2025)
FY2026 revenue guidance	**$4.80B** (~21% YoY)	Q3 FY2026 earnings (Dec 2, 2025)
Non-GAAP net income (FY2025)	**$987.6M** ($3.93/share)	CrowdStrike IR
Free cash flow (FY2025)	**$1.065B** (27% margin)	CrowdStrike IR
Non-GAAP operating margin	**21%** (Q3 FY2026)	CrowdStrike IR
GAAP net income (FY2025)	**$(19.3M)** loss	Driven by $865M SBC + $60M outage costs
Cash on hand	**$4.80B** (Oct 31, 2025)	10-Q filing

Pre-IPO, CrowdStrike raised approximately **$481M** across five rounds (Series A through E), reaching unicorn status in 2017 and a $3.0–3.35B valuation at its June 2018 Series E ($200M, led by General Atlantic). Key early investors included Warburg Pincus (30.3% pre-IPO), Accel (20.3%), and CapitalG.

The July 2024 outage and remarkable recovery

On July 19, 2024, a faulty Falcon sensor content update caused **8.5 million Windows devices** to crash globally — grounding airlines, disrupting banks, and shutting down 911 systems. Fortune 500 losses were estimated at **$5.4 billion** (Parametrix). CrowdStrike's stock dropped ~11% immediately.

The recovery has been extraordinary. **Dollar-based gross retention held above 97%** — down less than half a percentage point. Direct costs to CrowdStrike totaled $60.1M in FY2025 and $101.6M in the first nine months of FY2026, primarily legal fees (including the ongoing Delta Air Lines lawsuit seeking ~$500M). By Q3 FY2026, CrowdStrike posted **record net new ARR of $265M** (+73% QoQ), with management declaring it "one of our best quarters in company history." Crowdstrike The stock recovered to an all-time high of $557.53 in November 2025 MacroTrends before settling around $422.

Scale and platform depth

CrowdStrike serves approximately **30,000 subscription customers**, including **~60% of the Fortune 500**. The module adoption metrics reveal powerful cross-sell dynamics: **49% of customers use 6+ modules, 34% use 7+, and 24% use 8+** (Q3 FY2026). The Falcon Flex subscription model — allowing customers to swap modules annually — now represents **>$1.35B in ending ARR** from Flex accounts, growing 200%+ YoY.

The company employs approximately **11,075 people** globally, headquartered in Austin, Texas, with **~33% of revenue from international markets**. CrowdStrike has executed 12+ acquisitions since 2017, most recently **SGNL ($750M, identity security) and Seraphic Security ($420M, browser security)** in January 2026.

The Falcon platform spans **20+ product modules** across endpoint security, cloud security, identity protection, next-gen SIEM (via Humio/LogScale), data protection, IT operations, threat intelligence, and managed services. Morningstar Pricing is per-endpoint: **Falcon Go starts at ~$30/device/year** for SMBs, scaling to **~$185/device/year** for Enterprise bundles, with custom pricing for Elite/MDR tiers. CyCognito

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How these three companies actually compete

Vanta and Drata are in a direct dogfight

These two are the clearest head-to-head competitors in the market. Both sell "Trust Management Platforms" to companies that need compliance certifications (SOC 2, ISO 27001, HIPAA) to close enterprise deals. TechMagic The competitive dynamics break down by segment:

Startups and SMBs: Vanta wins. Three-quarters of each YC cohort uses Vanta. Sacra Its brand is synonymous with "first SOC 2" in the startup ecosystem. G2 data shows 58% of Vanta reviews come from small businesses. Comp AI Faster onboarding, simpler setup, and the network effect of being the default startup choice create a durable advantage.

Mid-market: a competitive tie. Drata edges slightly on customization depth and auditor collaboration tools. Vanta leads on breadth of integrations (375+ vs. 170+) and monitoring frequency (hourly vs. daily). Vanta Both are investing heavily in this segment, where average deal sizes climb toward $25,000–$50,000/yr.

Enterprise: Vanta gaining, Drata responding with M&A. Vanta is actively displacing legacy GRC tools in Fortune 500 accounts and has strategic investor relationships (CrowdStrike, Atlassian, Workday) that open doors. Drata countered with the **$250M SafeBase acquisition**, Sacra which brought enterprise logos like LinkedIn, Palantir, and CrowdStrike. The SafeBase deal was arguably Drata's most important strategic move — it immediately closed the Trust Center gap and added credibility with large enterprises. Drata's G2 rating of **4.8/5** slightly exceeds Vanta's **4.6/5**, Comp AI though Vanta has more reviews.

CrowdStrike is complementary, not competitive

CrowdStrike provides the security controls that Vanta and Drata measure and report on. The relationship is **symbiotic**: CrowdStrike detects threats, Vanta/Drata prove the detection is happening. CrowdStrike has invested in Vanta since 2022 TechCrunch and has a published joint solution brief. Both Vanta and Drata integrate deeply with CrowdStrike's Falcon platform to pull endpoint deployment data, vulnerability scan results, and prevention policy evidence.

CrowdStrike does have a **Falcon Cloud Security compliance module** (CSPM with CIS/NIST/HIPAA dashboards) and supports compliance use cases through certifications (FedRAMP High, ISO 27001, SOC 2). (SiliconANGLE) But it does not compete on audit preparation, multi-framework management, questionnaire automation, or trust centers — the core value propositions of Vanta and Drata.

The whitespace nobody is filling well

AI governance compliance is the most urgent gap. The EU AI Act requires high-risk AI system compliance by August 2026. Over 1,100 AI-related bills were introduced across U.S. states in 2025. Colorado's AI Act takes effect in 2026. ISO 42001 is becoming table stakes. Only Vanta and Drata have added ISO 42001 support, but neither offers the deeper capabilities AI governance demands — model drift monitoring, bias detection, explainability documentation, or automated risk classification. Compliance costs for AI add approximately **17% overhead** to AI system expenses. Dedicated AI governance tools (Holistic AI, Credo AI) exist but are not integrated into compliance automation platforms.

SMB-affordable compliance remains underserved. With entry points at $7,500–$10,000/yr, both Vanta and Drata price out very small businesses (under 50 employees) that increasingly need compliance to win customers. The 33.2 million SMBs in the U.S. represent a massive untapped market. Sprinto ($4–5K entry) and emerging players like Comp AI are starting to address this, but no dominant player has emerged below the $5K/yr threshold.

International and regional frameworks lag. DORA (effective January 2025), NIS2, and the EU AI Act create enormous compliance demand across Europe. (Persistence Market Research) APAC regulations are proliferating — Korea's Basic AI Act and Vietnam's AI law both take effect in 2026. Latin America (LGPD in Brazil) and the Middle East are growing markets with minimal coverage. Both Vanta and Drata have ~25% non-U.S. revenue, (SaaStr) but framework coverage remains heavily U.S.-centric.

Industry-specific deep compliance is fragmented. CMMC 2.0 for defense contractors, HIPAA Security Rule overhaul for healthcare, (Business Wire) IEC 62443 for manufacturing/OT — each represents a specialized compliance need that horizontal platforms serve superficially. Vanta's VantaGov (FedRAMP, CMMC) (Business Wire) and Drata's FedRAMP support are steps forward, but government and defense compliance automation is still largely manual.

Conclusion: what an investor should remember

The compliance automation market is consolidating rapidly around **two clear leaders** — Vanta at roughly double Drata's scale — with a massive cybersecurity incumbent (CrowdStrike) serving as a strategic partner rather than competitor. Vanta's moat is its startup network effect and integration breadth; Sacra Drata's counter-strategy is aggressive M&A to close capability gaps. Both benefit from unprecedented **regulatory tailwinds**: the EU AI Act, DORA, NIS2, HIPAA overhaul, CMMC 2.0, and a patchwork of state-level AI laws are creating compliance demand that didn't exist two years ago. 36Kr

The broader GRC market is estimated at **$49–63B** (2024), growing at 13–16% CAGR, IMARC with the compliance automation sub-segment growing faster. Sacra CrowdStrike, at $4.92B ARR Business Wire and targeting $10B, Crowdstrike represents the endpoint security layer these compliance platforms sit atop. The July 2024 outage proved CrowdStrike's customer lock-in: 97%+ gross retention even after crashing 8.5 million devices globally. Cybersecurity Dive Harvard Business Review

Three investment-critical signals to watch: Drata's likely **IPO in 2026–2027** (CFO hired, layoffs completed, $100M ARR crossed); Vanta's path to **profitability disclosure** as it approaches a potential $300M+ ARR run rate; and whether either platform successfully captures the **AI governance compliance wave** before a vertical-specific competitor does.